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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
E121/ EL121N
Introduction to Literature
Main- All Branches
Final Exam
2025-2026 / First Semester
Date: 20 Jan. 2026
9:30-11:30

umber of Exam Pages: 4 cluding this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 hours

STRUCTION

ear Students,

1. This exam consists of three parts.
2. Read each question carefully and follow the instructions provided.
3. Write all answers in ink (do not use pencil).
4. Edit and proofread your language before submitting.
5. Write all answers in the answer booklet provided.

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Part I: (5 marks each term)

Write a short paragraph (50 words) on any TWO of the following terms or concepts, using examples from literary works you are familiar with.

a. Flashback
b. Theme
c. Mood
d. Speaker

Part II: Obligatory (10 marks)

Read the following poem, then answer the questions below.

If I can stop one heart from breaking,
I shall not live in vain;
If I can ease one life the aching,
Or cool one pain,
Or help one fainting robin* * a small, well-loved bird
Unto his nest again,
I shall not live in vain.

- Emily Dickinson

Questions.

1. Give a suitable title to the poem. (2 marks)
2. What is the rhyme scheme of the poem. (2 marks)
3. What does the repeated phrase "I shall not live in vain" emphasize? Explain. (3 marks)
4. Choose the correct answer. Write the question number and the letter of your choice in the answer booklet. (3 marks)

1. What is the central theme of the poem?
A) Nature and seasons
B) Compassion and helping others
C) Love and romance
D) Death and immortality

2. In the line, "Or help one fainting robin unto his nest again," what does the robin symbolize?
A) Danger in the wild
B) Wealth and success
C) Happiness and joy
D) Vulnerable creatures needing care

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3. How does the speaker suggest a life can be meaningful?
A) By achieving fame and fortune
B) By stopping one heart from breaking or easing one pain
C) By traveling the world
D) By avoiding challenges

4. Which literary device is most prominent in the poem?
A) Irony
B) Personification
C) Alliteration
D) Imagery

5. Which of the following best describes the speaker's attitude toward helping others in the poem?
A) Indifferent and detached
B) Angry and resentful
C) Hopeful and committed
D) Confused and uncertain

6. The tone of the poem can best be described as:
A) Angry and accusatory
B) Sad and mournful
C) Reflective and compassionate
D) Humorous and playful

Part III: (15 marks each question)

Write a 200-250 word essay on TWO of the following three topics.

Question 1: Protagonists often evolve emotionally, morally, or psychologically as a story unfolds. Considering Michael Obi in *Dead Men's Path*, the boy in *A Handful of Dates*, and the narrator in *Letter from Gaza*, which character experiences the most significant change? Support your answer with examples from the texts.

Question 2: Who is responsible for Nora's decision to leave home at the end of Henrik Ibsen's play "A Doll's House"? Support your discussion with specific references from the play.

Question 3: In *"Harlem,"* Langston Hughes explores how the deferral of dreams leads to loss and decay—of hope, dignity, and humanity. How does Hughes use imagery to communicate this theme? Support your answer with examples from the poem.

(The poem is in the next page)

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Harlem

By Langston Hughes

What happens to a dream deferred?

Does it dry up

like a raisin in the sun?

Or fester like a sore—

And then run?

Does it stink like rotten meat?

Or crust and sugar over—

like a syrupy sweet?

Maybe it just sags

like a heavy load.

Or does it explode?

End of the Exam

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